3.4 Derivatives of Logarithmic Functions

Name _____ Period ____ Date _____

AP Calculus 3.4 · Student sheet

I can…

- find the derivatives of ln x, ln u, and log_b x.
- find the derivative of b^x.
- use logarithmic differentiation, including when the variable is in the base and the exponent.

Vocabulary · fill in the missing word

Derivative of ln x — d/dx ln x = _____, x > 0

Derivative of log_b x — d/dx log_b x = _____

Logarithmic differentiation — take ln of both sides, use log _____, differentiate implicitly, then solve for y′

e as a limit — e = _____

Part 1 · Slope of ln x

y = ln x: read the slope of the tangent line.

x	1/2	1	2	4
Slope				

Part 2 · Notes and examples (fill in each note, then work the example)

Natural log: d/dx ln x = 1/x, and d/dx ln u = _____.

Example 1

Find each derivative.

a. $y = \ln(x^2 + 5)$

b. $y = x \ln x$

Rewrite first: use log properties so that ln of a product or quotient becomes a _____ or difference of logs.

Example 2

$f(x) = \ln\left[\frac{2x + 1}{x + 3}\right]$. Find $f'(0)$.

Other bases: d/dx log_b x = 1/(x ln b) and d/dx b^x = _____.

Example 3

Find each derivative.

a. $y = \log_2 x$

b. $y = 5^x$

Logarithmic differentiation: take ln of both sides, differentiate, then multiply by _____.

Example 4

Find y' for $y = x^x$, $x > 0$.

e as a limit: the limit as $n \to \infty$ of $(1 + a/n)^n$ = _____.

Example 5

Find the limit as $n \to \infty$ of $(1 + \frac{2}{n})^n$.

Part 3 · Partner practice

Partner 1

$f(x) = \ln(x^2 + 4)$. Find $f'(2)$.

Partner 2

(AP® Practice) If $h(x) = \ln(x^2 + 4)$, then $h'(x)$ equals

(A) $\frac{2x}{x^2 + 4}$ (B) $\frac{1}{x^2 + 4}$ (C) $\frac{x^2}{x^2 + 4}$ (D) $\left|\frac{2x}{x^2 + 4}\right|$